

Fawaz Sammani

fawaz.sammani@vub.be | +32474173645 | Brussels, Belgium

GitHub:fawazsammani

CURRENT POSITION

3rd Year PhD Student at Vrije Universiteit Brussel, ETRO Department

Research Interests: Vision-Language, Zero-shot learning, Inference-time approaches, Generative AI

EDUCATION

- **2020 – 2022:** Masters of Applied Computer Science (Coursework-Based), Vrije Universiteit Brussel (VUB). GPA: 83%, Great Distinction. Thesis Topic: *Visualizing and Understanding Self-Supervised Vision Learning*
- **2019 – 2020:** Masters of Engineering Science (Research-Based), Multimedia University, Topic: *Deep Learning-Based EEG Signal Analysis of Stroke Patients* – Not Continued
- **2015 – 2019:** Bachelor of Engineering (Honours) Electronics Majoring in Robotics and Automation with First Class Honours (CGPA: 3.74), Multimedia University (MMU)

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Ada Gorgun***, **Fawaz Sammani***, **Nikos Deligiannis**, **Bernt Schiele**, **Jonas Fischer**, Nikos Deligiannis, *Temporal Concept Dynamics in Diffusion Models via Prompt-Conditioned Interventions*, International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2026 (* equal contribution)
2. **Fawaz Sammani**, Nikos Deligiannis, *Zero-Shot Natural Language Explanations*, International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2025
3. **Fawaz Sammani**, Nikos Deligiannis, *Interpreting and Analysing CLIP's Zero-Shot Image Classification via Mutual Knowledge*, Neural Information and Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2024
4. **Fawaz Sammani**, Boris Joukovsky, Nikos Deligiannis, *Visualizing and Understanding Contrastive Learning*, IEEE Transactions on Image Processing (TIP), vol. 33, pp. 541-555, 2024
5. **Fawaz Sammani**, Nikos Deligiannis, *Uni-NLX: Unifying Textual Explanations for Vision and Vision-Language Tasks*, International Conference on Computer Vision Workshops (ICCVW) 2023, (Vision-and-Language Algorithmic Reasoning Workshop 2023), Oral Presentation (**Honorable Mention Award**)
6. Boris Joukovsky, **Fawaz Sammani**, Nikos Deligiannis, *Model-Agnostic Visual Explanations via Approximate Bilinear Models*, International Conference on Image Processing (ICIP) 2023
7. **Fawaz Sammani**, Tanmoy Mukherjee, Nikos Deligiannis, *NLX-GPT: A Model for Natural Language Explanations in Vision and Vision-Language Tasks*, Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) 2022 (**Oral Presentation**)
8. **Fawaz Sammani**, Luke-Melas Kyriazi, *Show, Edit and Tell: A Framework for Editing Image Captions*, Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) 2020
9. **Fawaz Sammani**, Kok Swee Sim, *Encoding Rich Frequencies for Classification of Stroke Patients EEG Signals*, IEEE Access 2020
10. **Fawaz Sammani**, Mahmoud El-Sayed, *Look and Modify: Modification Networks for Image Captioning*, British Machine Vision Conference (BMVC) 2019

SUMMER SCHOOLS

- Attended the International Computer Vision Summer School (ICVSS) 2023, Sicily, Italy

RESEARCH VISITS

- Max Planck Institute for Informatics, Explainable Machine Learning group, Department of Computer Vision and Machine Learning, December 2024 - February 2025

REVIEWER

I served as a reviewer for the following venues (most recent first): CVPR 2026, ICLR 2026, NeurIPS 2025, ICML 2025, CVPR 2025, ICLR 2025, NeurIPS 2024, ECCV 2024, ICCV 2023, BMVC 2024, BMVC 2023. I also review regularly for Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR)

TEACHING

Teaching assistant (teaching practical sessions, assigning and correcting projects, creating theory and practical material) for the Deep Learning course, Masters of Applied Computer Science (MACS), Vrije Universiteit Brussel, for Academic Years 2022-2023, 2023-2024, 2024-2025, 2025-2026

SUPERVISION

I have supervised the following Master Thesis projects:

- Natural Language Explanations for Medical Imaging, by *Tolga Dinc*
- Parameter-Efficient Inference-Time Fine-Tuning of GPT-2: Exploring Feature Inversion to Privacy Attacks, by *Alex-Mihai Lapusan*
- Vizualizing and Understanding Semi-Supervised Learning, by *Malek Boudiaf*

TALKS

- Best of NeurIPS 2024 Virtual Event by Voxel51

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

- FWO (Fonds Wetenschappelijk Onderzoek) Grant for a long stay abroad
- FWO (Fonds Wetenschappelijk Onderzoek) PhD Fellowship Strategic Basic Research - FWOTM1219: Towards Human Friendly Explanations (01/11/2023 - 31/10/2027)
- VUB Masters Scholarship Programme 2020-2021
- VUB Masters Scholarship Programme 2021-2022
- TM R&D – MMU Graduate Research Assistant Scholarship
- Awarded 6 times the Dean's List Award at Multimedia University (Bachelors)

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (DURING BACHELOR DEGREE)

- Director of Future Leaders Program 2016/17 organized by the Students' Representative Council
- Vice President of International Student Society term 2017/18
- Officer of Public Relations in Students' Representative Council 2016/17
- Officer of Public Relations in Career Fair 2018 Multimedia University
- Assistant Director for International Student Society Night 2018 (Winning Event for Best Integration Program)